4.8 Cardiac Dysrhythmias

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My heart is racing and I feel dizzy." **Objective** • Pulse irregular at 140/min (atrial fibrillation) • BP 100/64 mmHg	**ACTUAL** **Decreased cardiac output** related to altered heart rate and rhythm as evidenced by irregular tachycardia, dizziness and low BP.	Within 24 hours, ventricular rate controlled and BP stable.	• Continuous ECG monitoring. • Take the apical and radial pulse at the same time. • Give rate- or rhythm-control drugs as prescribed. • If ordered, prepare for cardioversion. • Follow electrolytes.	HR controlled, BP stable: **goal met**.
Subjective • "What is wrong with my heart?" **Objective** • Looks anxious • Keeps glancing at the monitor	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety** related to irregular heartbeat as evidenced by worry and questions.	Says she is less anxious within 24 hours.	• Explain her rhythm and its treatment in simple words. • Explain why she is monitored and what the alarms mean. • Invite her questions. • Teach slow breathing.	Calm: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Atrial fibrillation	**RISK** **Risk for ineffective cerebral tissue perfusion** as evidenced by risk factors: atrial fibrillation and risk of embolism.	No stroke.	• Give the anticoagulant as prescribed. • Check neurological status. • Teach the warning signs of stroke.	No neurological change: **goal met**.